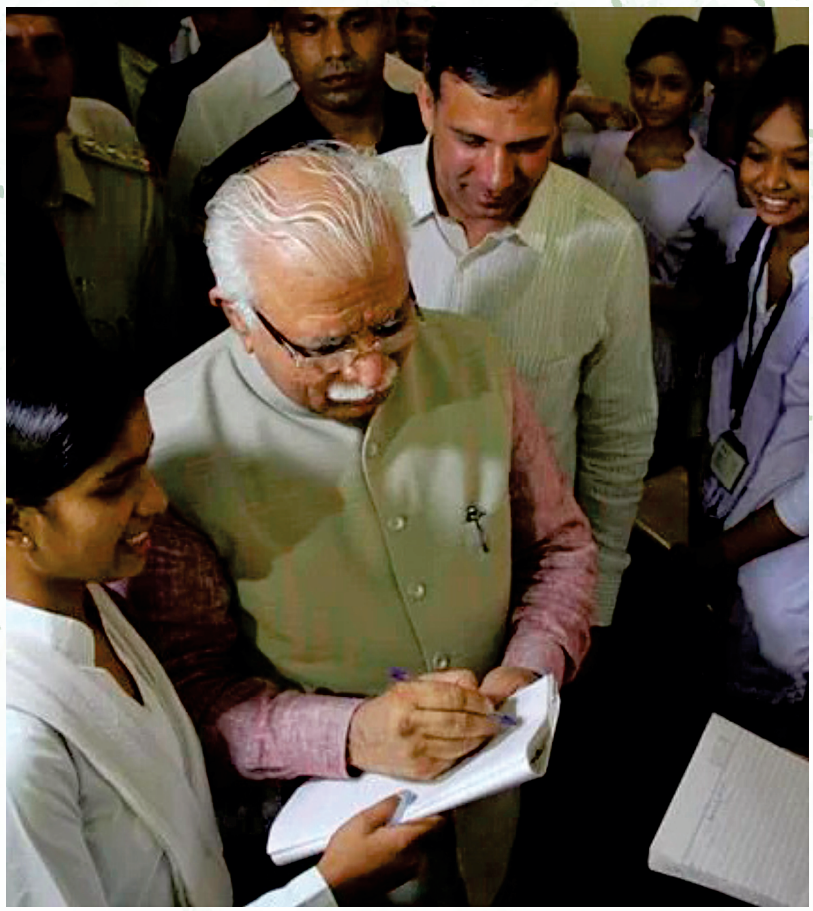
Technology and IIT Bombay's Edtech Tulna research team to understand frameworks for evaluating PAL software products. With expert support, the government created a Haryana Tulna (comparison) evaluation framework and designed a multi-step procurement process to ensure technical quality evaluation and price discovery. The procurement process took about six months with multiple rounds of evaluations by a committee comprising government officials, members of academia and experts from Indian and global organisations.

"Ghar Se Padhao" Initiative

During COVID-19 it was a new challenge for children as they could not go to their schools and the entire education system looked to be derailed. As soon as the national lockdown was announced, Haryana was quick to respond to the unprecedented situation and within a short span made an arrangement to connect almost all of our 24 lakh government school students with their teachers through thousands of Whatsapp groups.

Under the "Ghar Se Padhao" programme, the state government made sure to send academic content to students on a daily basis. They were also given weekly quizzes and worksheets for practice. Teachers rose to the occasion by conducting home visits and keeping in touch with students regularly through phone calls. Cognizant that many students had limited access to digital devices and the importance of leveraging the community during this unprecedented time.

The state government also launched "Shiksha Mitra" programme under which any friend, neighbour or relative could give his mobile to a student to help them access academic resources. At the peak of the pandemic, the government was able to engage with over 90% of the 2.5 million government school students in the state through learning videos, worksheets and quizzes. The government was cognizant that



technology couldn't be a substitute for classroom interaction, but it saw the value of Edtech as a supplement to classroom learning.

Prashnavali

Following the Prime Minister's mooted digital learning portal, Diksha, the Haryana government was quick to follow it and launch a web application called "Prashnavali" which enables digital creation of assessment questions, question papers and videos for government and private schools. It also allows creation of a reusable question bank repository and tags each question to skills and competencies. Prashnavali was developed through close collaboration among the Centre, the state government, Sunbird and Samagra Governance. Prashnavali solves the challenge of building reusable question back repositories but also enables school systems to move towards practice-based learning and competency-based assessments in classrooms. Haryana, in fact, has been one of the pioneer states in adopting Prashnavali for state-wide use.

NAS Assessment

The results of the National Achievement Survey (NAS)-2021 hold a key lesson for Haryana. When the entire system perseveres to achieve an outcome, success will follow. Across grades and subjects, Haryana's performance has improved by leaps and bounds, breaching the top-10. Grade 10 government school students in the state have been ranked 3rd in India across all subjects. In grades 3 and 5, Haryana has jumped up 20 spots in the ranking for EVS and Math, while grade 8 students have been ranked 2nd in language. This is the story of a new Haryana, which can no longer be considered a laggard when it comes to education. The results of the National Achievement Survey (NAS)-2021 have come as a shot in the arm for Haryana.